

This expression will match two URLs on your site -

- `folderone/thanks`
as well as
- `foldertwo/thanks`

So what does this mean, you ask. Let's rewind to your 3rd or 4th grade mathematics lesson where you teacher told you that if you have to solve an equation that uses various parameters, always remember that division and multiplication needs to be performed before you get to the addition and subtraction part i.e. BODMAS rule.

- $3 + 5 \times 2 = 13$
(5 times two equals 10, plus 3 equals 13)

If you wanted a different execution to the same equation, you would have to force it with the use of parentheses -

- $(3 + 5) \times 2 = 16$

And that's the value of parentheses in mathematics. The same numbers can give you different answers, basis its use.

So what about Regex, how do we use parentheses here? So let's look at a Regex example -

Remember the example we used to explain pipes in Regex. Let's begin with that.

- `confirmation|thanks`

But what will happen when we want to grab everything on either side of the pipe.

`/foldertwo/thanks` and `/folderone/thanks` can then be represented as

- `/folder(one|two)/thanks`

Square Brackets & Dashes [-]

Square brackets and dashes are being explained together because they very often go together. They are useful in making simple lists. But these simple lists can help you save a lot of time in advanced filter searches.

For instance, if you were to group `[aiu]` as a list, and use it in the following manner - `b[aiu]n`, it can be interpreted as ban, bin or bun. It will not use more than one alphabet inside the bracket while making these interpretations. Getting that to happen will need additional Regex. More on that later. The moment you add a dash, you make the list include everything that is between the start and end point of the characters mentioned inside the square brackets.

`[a-z]` is all the alphabets of the English language in lower case